

Aviv Gelfand

📍 Jerusalem, Israel

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Summary

- Hands-on Applied Data Scientist with a proven record of building and deploying real-world AI and NLP solutions in startup, academic, and military settings.
- Skilled in LLMs, prompt engineering, and production ML pipelines. Passionate about using data science to drive impactful, user-centered applications.
- MSc candidate in Data Science (Hebrew University, LLM-focused thesis), on a flexible schedule, structured to prioritize a full-time role at a DS/ML/AI team.

Experience

Data Scientist

2024 – present

Darrow AI - Data Science Team

- Designed and deployed an end-to-end pipelines that detected a \$1M+ needle in large medical data sets.
- Conducted in-depth Error Analysis to improve automation efficacy. Delivered under tight operational deadlines and cross-functional collaboration.
- Leveraged few-shot Chain-of-Thought LLM prompting, optimised costs with OpenAI's Batch API, enriched and filtered leads databases with medical domains intelligence, integrating multi-source enrichment.
- Designed Airflow pipelines integrated with model endpoints, querying AWS S3 data lakes, OpenSearch, and PostgreSQL. Built containerized components using Docker; collaborated with DEs, PMs, and product stakeholders.

NLP Data Scientist & Research Assistant

2023 – 2024

Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Adi Leibovitch's Quantitative Legal Research lab

- Executed Supervised-Fine-Tuning of open-source LLMs to classify textual argument-types in trials; reduced labeling time and errors, replacing manual tagging with LLM-based tagging. Applied PEFT and LoRA with Hugging Face transformers and PyTorch.
- Achieved over 90% accuracy and 80% F1 scores in most target labels. Saved days of model complexity and training time using efficient sampling, overcoming significant imbalance.
- Presented findings and achievements at a prominent statistics and data science conference in May 2024.

Statistics & Machine Learning Instructor

2022 – 2024

Upscale Analytics

- Built dozens of hands-on ML projects as assignments for a practical course in statistical inference and classic ML, with constant feedback from a Senior Data Scientist (and head lecturer), Michael Winer.
- Advanced from teaching assistant to instructor, then to a full rights partner after 3 successful semesters of weekly TA sessions with a significant presence of students. Worked primarily with Scikit-Learn, SciPy, and XGBoost Libraries.

Data Analyst & Economic Research Team Leader

2015 – 2020

Israel Defense Forces (Volunteered, Lieutenant)

- Conducted research, threat assessments, and analysis for senior decision-makers and enhanced output capacity.
- Led cross-org initiatives, yielding in-depth research papers via unprecedented cooperations with research branches.

Education

The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

2024 – present

MSc in Data Science — ML-focused Thesis, guided by Prof. Ariel Jaffe

The Hebrew University of Jerusalem

2021 – 2024

BSc in Statistics & Data Science and Business Administration (GPA 89)

Skills and Technologies

Languages and Tools: Python, SQL, Java, Solidity (C++ based), R, JS;

LLM & GenAI: Prompt Engineering (CoT, Few-Shot, eg.), OpenAI APIs, HF Transformers, PEFT, LoRA

ML & NLP: Classification, Clustering, Anomaly Detection, Scikit-learn, PyTorch, model evaluation, smart sampling

Data Handling: Pandas, NumPy, PostgreSQL, OpenSearch, S3, DataGrip

CI/CD, Automation & Infra: AWS (S3, ECS, SSM, Parameter Store), Apache Airflow, Docker, DataDog, Shell scripts, GitHub & GitLab

Business & Risk: Strategic analytics, stakeholder collaboration, operational research models, and financial acumen